INTRODUCTION

As a central concept in the present day international scenario, globalization is hard to define. Still, scholars have made attempts to provide a basic understanding of the concept. The concept has got inextricably linked with the process of transformation touching upon every aspect of social, political and economic development around the globe. It can be seen as a process by which the population of the world is increasingly bonded into a single society. In the social front, globalization signifies closer interaction of people and homogenization of culture and values and the world being transformed into a 'global village'. Politically, it refers to the complex networks of global governance and shared political values resulting in the development of a tendency towards homogenization of global political culture. Economically, it is manifested in the form of liberalization tendencies, privatization, deregulation leading to a free market regime. On a greater plane, globalization has posed challenges to the raison d$prime$$être of the states—the dominant actors in international relations.